

Louis Andrada
Born 2002 in Mossoró, Brazil
Based in Toronto, Canada - 2026
www.louisandrada.com

Artist Statement

I am a Brazilian-born, Toronto-based artist.

Since childhood, I found it difficult to express myself to others. It created a distance between my internal experiences and the world around me. Instead, through horror movies and folklore, I found comfort and a way to explore emotions that were difficult to understand.

My practice originates in the merging of my fascination with occult symbolism and my attempt to express unexplored emotions. Each work is less an invention than an extraction, taking what already exists internally and forcing it into visibility.

A lot of my technical foundation comes from analog film photography and darkroom production. This training established how I think about images: through grain, tonal contrast, chemical disruption, and forms that develop slowly and resist full resolution. Although I no longer produce commercial photographs, these processes continue to exist within my approach to painting.

Surfaces are built through sequential pigment layering that simulates exposure, degradation, and controlled deterioration. Figures emerge gradually, caught between visibility and collapse.

Painting functions as a form of containment. In the process of giving form to what I fear most, my images erode and resist full resolution; they do not want to be fully seen.

I truly believe artworks should continue to exist beyond the artist, allowing each viewer to encounter them through their own memories, fears, and experiences.